Colour and Font Guide: Family Clinic and Medical Aid

Based on the dashboards' real colours and the fonts in the code (`app/ui/fonts.ts`): Inter for the interface and Lusitana for serif headings.

1. The big idea (one sentence)

Deep midnight and royal blues say "trust and professionalism", periwinkle adds a friendly, modern energy, a warm serif headline says "a real person is looking after you", and a clean sans-serif keeps every date, number and button easy to read. The Medical Aid dashboard adds one teal accent so it reads as its own area of the same family.

2. The palette

Midnight	Indigo navy	Royal blue	Periwinkle	Sky blue	Mist	Teal
#0F172A	#1E2F66	#1E4FD8	#5B7FFF	#9CC9FF	#F4F8FC	#0D9488
Landing header, plans panel, headings	Main buttons, active tab, featured plan	Clinic logo, call-to-action buttons	Highlighted words, badge, accent bar	Wallet card bar, light accents	Page and tab backgrounds	Medical Aid accent and logo (new)

Roughly: about 60% light neutral (mist and white cards), 30% midnight and indigo navy, 10% royal blue and periwinkle accents. The Family Clinic and Next.js areas stay in one blue family. Teal is used only for the Medical Aid card, logo and gradient on the landing page, so it signals "different dashboard" without changing the clinic design.

3. Colour theory: why one blue family works

Idea	Meaning	Where you can see it
Monochromatic / analogous	One hue family with different lightness	Midnight, indigo, royal, periwinkle and sky are all blues: unified, calm, trustworthy.
Value hierarchy	Dark means important, light means supporting	Dark navy buttons and the active tab stand out; mist backgrounds stay quiet.
Temperature	Cool colours calm, warm colours alert	Every main colour is cool, so nothing in the clinic feels alarming.
Accent for identity	One different hue marks a different area	The teal shield-and-cross marks Medical Aid beside the blue clinic and black Next.js logos.
Dark section for emphasis	A contrasting block draws the eye	The midnight plans panel makes pricing the focus; the featured Family Plus card is lifted.
Colour-coded by lightness	Categories told apart by shade	The overview cards use four blue shades as top bars, so they work for colour-blind users.

4. Symbolism for a family clinic

Symbolism is associative, not scientific law, and varies by culture. Say "commonly associated with".

Element	Common association	Why it suits the clinic
Midnight / navy	Authority, seriousness, security	Patients trust the clinic with medical and personal information.
Royal blue	Trust, reliability, professionalism	Widely used in healthcare; on the clinic logo and key buttons.
Periwinkle	Friendliness, approachability	Softens the formality so a family feels welcome.
Sky blue / mist	Calm, cleanliness, openness	Light surfaces feel clean and uncluttered, like a tidy practice.

Element	Common association	Why it suits the clinic
Teal	Health, balance, protection	Pairs with the shield-and-cross logo to say "cover" for Medical Aid.
Heart-in-hands logo	Care, support, protection	Heart means compassion; open hands mean help and safety.

5. Typography: a serif and sans pairing

Role	Style	Where it appears	Why it works
Headlines	Lusitana (warm serif)	"Welcome to your Family Clinic portal.", "Sign in to the Family Clinic dashboard.", Care Plans headings	Serifs read as human and established: a trusted family doctor's voice.
Interface and body	Inter (clean sans-serif)	Buttons, tabs, labels, cards, numbers, plan prices (R199, R549, R899)	Crisp at small sizes; even digits make appointments and prices easy to scan.

SAY: "I paired a serif for headlines with a clean sans-serif for the interface. The serif gives the clinic a warm, trustworthy voice, and the sans-serif keeps the dashboard clear and easy to use."

Hierarchy: tiny letter-spaced eyebrow ("HEALTH CARE") above the clinic name; large serif headline in midnight with key words in periwinkle; medium grey sans support text; bold sans buttons, filled for the main action and outlined for the secondary; big bold numbers in stat cards.

6. Fonts confirmed

The fonts are confirmed from the code: `app/ui/fonts.ts` imports **Inter** and **Lusitana** (weights 400 and 700) from `next/font/google`. Use these names on slides.

7. Contrast (accessibility)

WCAG asks 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text (about 24px, or 19px bold).

Pair	Ratio	Result
Midnight text on page background	16.96 : 1	Passes normal text
White text on indigo button	12.70 : 1	Passes normal text
White text on royal-blue button	6.63 : 1	Passes normal text
Periwinkle on white (large headline words)	3.54 : 1	Large text only
White on periwinkle (small badge)	3.54 : 1	Large text only
Sky blue text on midnight	10.38 : 1	Passes normal text
White text on midnight	17.85 : 1	Passes normal text
White text on teal (#0D9488) button	3.74 : 1	Large or bold text only: keep button text bold and 16px or more

Takeaway: periwinkle and teal are best for large headline highlights, icons and bars; keep small text white-on-navy or midnight-on-light. Never rely on colour alone for status; add a label.

8. Dark mode palette

The moon button remaps the same blue family for dark mode (`html.dark` in `app/ui/global.css`). Page and cards become deep navy, text becomes near-white, and links and accents are lightened so they stay readable.

Role	Colour	Contrast check
Page background	#0B1324	Near-white text #E5E9F5 on it: 15.28 : 1
Card background	#111A2E	Text #E5E9F5: 14.29 : 1. Muted text #9AA6C4: 7.12 : 1

Role	Colour	Contrast check
Links and accents	#8FA8FF on cards	7.61 : 1, passes normal text
Medical Aid teal	#2DD4BF on cards, #5EEAD4 on page	9.32 : 1 and 12.53 : 1
Buttons	White on #2B4190	9.29 : 1
Status colours	Green #4ADE80, amber #FCD34D, rose #FB7185 on dark tints	8.30 : 1, 9.23 : 1, 5.93 : 1

Every pair above clears 4.5:1, so dark mode is at least as readable as light mode. The choice is saved in the browser and applied before the page paints.

9. Ten-second script

"Midnight and royal blue signal trust and security. Periwinkle adds a friendly touch, and teal marks the Medical Aid area. A serif headline gives the clinic a warm, human voice, and a clean sans-serif keeps the dashboard easy to read."

10. Likely questions

Is dark mode accessible? Yes: text, links, buttons and status colours all exceed 4.5:1 on their dark backgrounds, and the choice is remembered.

Why a serif and a sans together? Serif for personality and warmth in headlines; sans for clarity in the interface. The contrast creates hierarchy.

Why mostly blues? One hue family looks cohesive and calm; shade creates hierarchy. Cool colours avoid alarming patients.

Why is Medical Aid teal? It is a separate dashboard, so one accent hue tells the three cards apart on the landing page while staying calm and health-related.

Why not red or green? Red signals danger and anxiety, and green is kept for success states, so neither is a main colour.

Is the contrast accessible? Main text and buttons exceed 4.5:1. Periwinkle and teal are limited to large or bold text and decoration.

Where did you research this? Name one or two real sources you read, for example the WCAG contrast guidance and the Google Fonts pages for Inter and Lusitana.